Network Types

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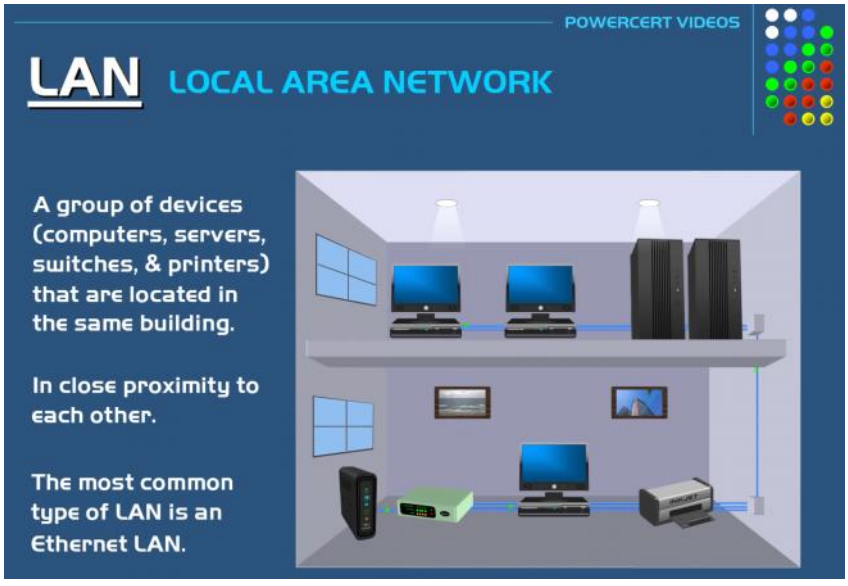
Network Types

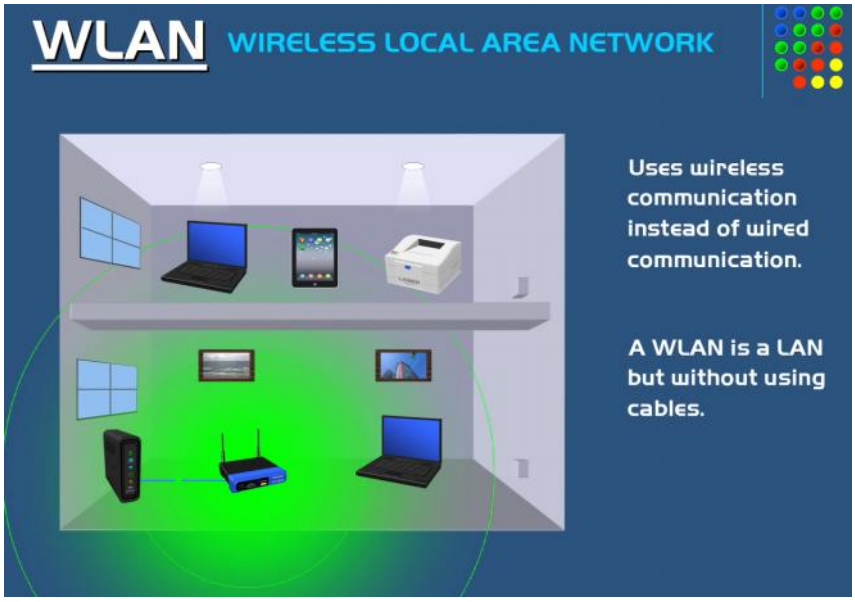
Computer networks are classified based on their size and geographic coverage.

PAN (Personal Area Network)
Very small network used to connect personal devices like phones, laptops, and tablets. Uses technologies such as Bluetooth, NFC, infrared, or USB for short range communication.

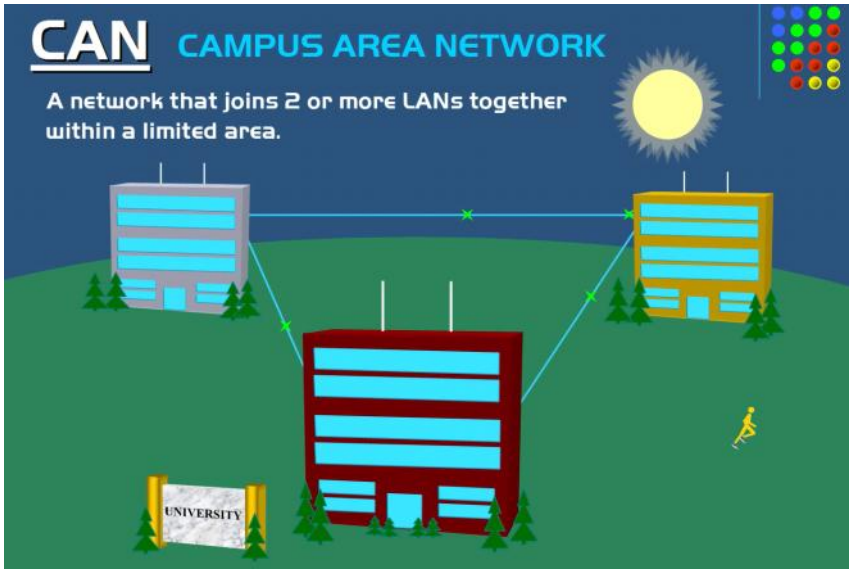
LAN (Local Area Network)
Connects devices within a small area such as a home, office, or single building. Commonly uses Ethernet cables or WiFi.



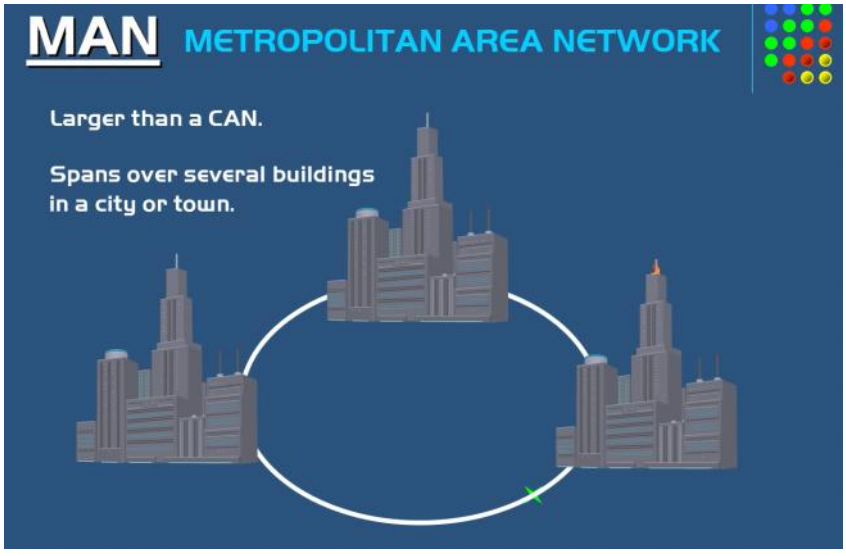
WLAN (Wireless Local Area Network)
A type of LAN that uses wireless communication instead of cables. Devices connect through WiFi routers or wireless access points.



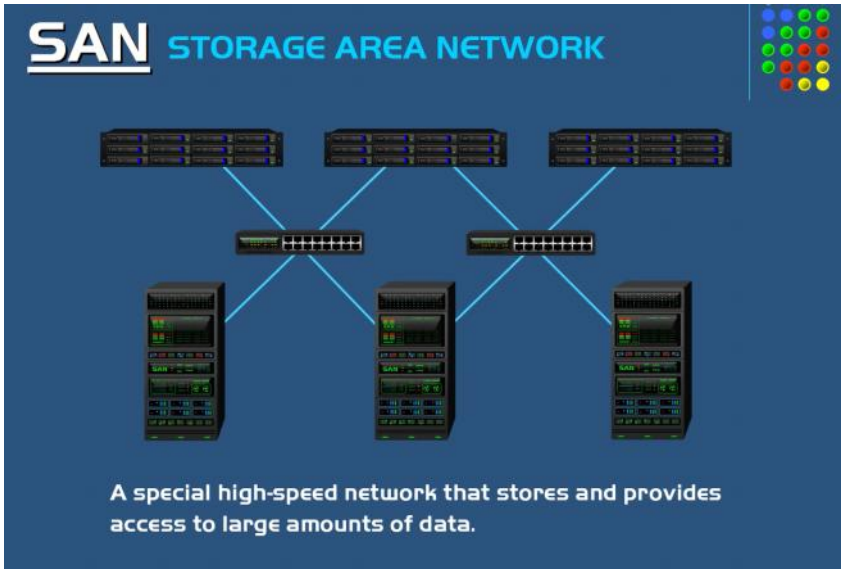
CAN (Campus Area Network)
Connects multiple LANs within a limited area such as a university campus or corporate campus.



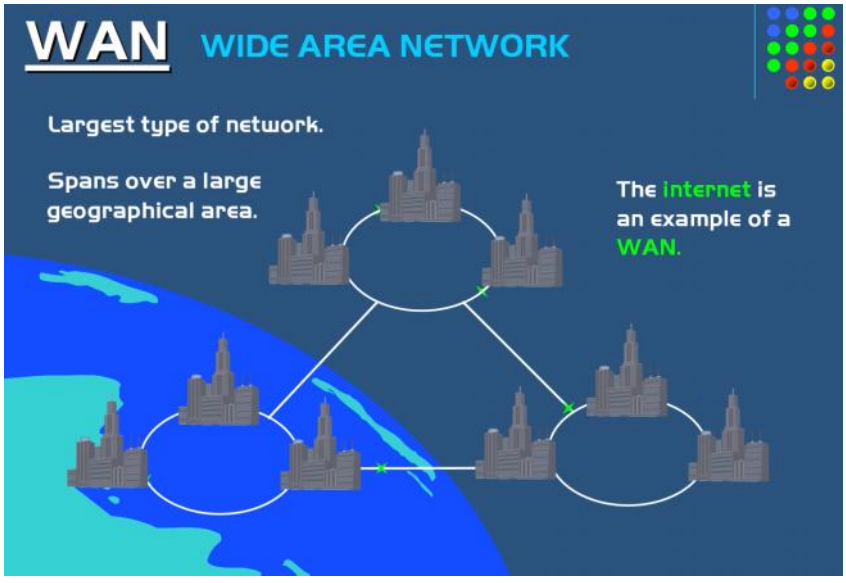
MAN (Metropolitan Area Network)
Covers a larger area like a city or town and usually uses high speed fiber connections to link many networks.



SAN (Storage Area Network)
A dedicated high speed network used only for storing and accessing large amounts of data. It connects storage devices and servers and is separate from normal network traffic.



WAN (Wide Area Network)
The largest type of network that connects multiple LANs, CANs, and MANs across countries or continents. The Internet is the most common example.



Key Idea
The main difference between these networks is their size and coverage area, starting from very small personal networks to large global networks.